

GREEN HOMES

Make your home energy efficient and avoid environmental toxins by using materials and resources in a responsible manner

BY SMITA TRIPATHI

WHEN 56-YEAR-OLD interior designer Revathi Nair was building her retirement home on the outskirts of Bengaluru, she was conscious

of the fact that it had to be sustainable. “I was constructing a house, so that was anyway adding to my carbon footprint. The least I could do was ensure it was sustainable,” she says.

A sustainable house is one that has the least possible impact on the environment. That means it is energy efficient and is built using materials with a low carbon footprint. “Sustainability is not restricted only to the environment but it’s also about the socio-economic impact. Construction is only a part of it; you need to think of the whole operation,” says Rosie Paul, Co-founder and Principal Architect of Bengaluru-based Masons Ink Studio, which specialises in sustainable homes. She recommends working with local and natural materials such as mud, rocks and stones, and engaging local labour. “That way you positively impact the community and help the local economy with labour and materials,” she says. Italian marble is a strict no-no, if you want to build a sustainable home.



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Mud, stone and reclaimed wood are the major materials used

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Think local, act local is the mantra used for the construction of this farmhouse

